Minister, I was not real y sure if he would clear our entire proposal. But he did. I was absolutely delighted!

The Defence Minister stood up, signal ing that the meeting was over. Turning to me he said, “Since I brought you here, I was expecting you to come up with something like this. I am happy to see your work.” In a split second, the mystery surrounding the clearance of my appointment as Director DRDL in 1982 was cleared. So it was Defence Minister Venkataraman who had brought me in! Bowing in thanks, I turned towards the door when I heard Dr Arunachalam tel ing the Minister about Zameela’s wedding being scheduled for that evening at Rameswaram. It amazed me that Dr Arunachalam should bring up this matter before the Minister. Why would a person of his stature, sitting in the al -powerful South Block, be concerned about a wedding which was to take place on a far-flung island in a smal house on Mosque Street?

I have always had a high regard for Dr Arunachalam. He has together with a command over language as he displayed on this occasion, an uncanny presence of mind. I was overwhelmed when the Defence Minister located an Air Force helicopter doing sorties between Madras and